

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣ K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣ 4

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥ J

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6 ♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠ 10

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 3

♥ A 9 8 4 3

♦ J 10 8 3

♣ Q J 4

♠ A K J 5

♥ K 6

♦ A Q 6 2

♣ 10 7 2



♠ 10 9 8 6

♥ 2

♦ 9 5 4

♣ A K 9 6 5

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ Q J 10 7 5

♦ K 7

♣ 8 3

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♣K

This is a companion hand to Deal 16.

NORTH shows four ♠s following SOUTH's Stayman bid.

So SOUTH ignores her five ♥s, having already found an 8-card Major suit fit. With the fit her hand now revalues to 11 points so she bids 4♠.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 7 4 2
 ♥ Q J 10 7 5
 ♦ K 7
 ♣ 8 3

♠ 10 3

♥ 9 8 3 2

♦ 9 5 4 3

♣ K Q 5



♠ A K 5

♥ K 6

♦ A Q 6 2

♣ J 10 7 2

♠ J 9 8 6

♥ A 4

♦ J 10 8

♣ A 9 6 4

*West**North**East**South*

2 ♣

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣4

This is companion #3 to Deal 16 and 17.

WEST again starts with Stayman, and after EAST denies a 4-card Major, WEST shows her five ♥s.

But in this Deal EAST has only a doubleton ♥, so he chooses to play 3NT.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 3

♥ J 10 8

♦ A 10 8 4 2

♣ 10 5

♠ K J

♥ A K 6

♦ J 9 5 3

♣ K J 9 6



♠ 9 2

♥ 9 4 2

♦ K Q 6

♣ 8 7 4 3 2

♠ Q 10 8 6 5 4

♥ Q 7 5 3

♦ 7

♣ A Q

Even with a 6-card ♠ suit SOUTH uses Stayman because he also has a 4-card ♥ suit. Given a choice, playing a 4-4 Major fit is usually preferable to a 6-2 or even a 6-3 fit.

But here NORTH doesn't have four ♥s so SOUTH just bids the game where he knows the partnership holds eight trumps.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Lead: ♥J

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 7
♥ K J 6 5
♦ A 8 4
♣ K Q 10 8

♠ 10 9 8 6 4

♥ 2

♦ J 10 7 2

♣ 7 6 3



♠ K Q 3
♥ Q 10 9 8 4 3
♦ K 5
♣ A 5

♠ J 5 2

♥ A 7

♦ Q 9 6 3

♣ J 9 4 2

WEST breaks the expected Transfer sequence by jumping to 3♥ instead of bidding just 2♥. This is called the "Super Accept" and it shows a hand with four of the trump suit with maximum point count.

EAST's ♣ bid and WEST's ♦ bid are Control bids, showing first round control of the suit that was bid.

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♦	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♦	Pass	6♥	

All Pass
6♥ by West
Lead: ♠ 10